

PREMIUM

Refusal Decision Guide

Judicial review, Letter of Acceptance issues, and reapplying with a stronger case

Understand your options after a refusal

Outcome	What it means	What you can do
Refusal	The IRCC visa officer wasn't satisfied you met the requirements - most commonly, financial evidence, a Letter of Acceptance mismatch, or a weak study plan.	No formal appeal for a refused Study Permit. Your options are a fresh application, or - in narrow circumstances - judicial review.
Judicial Review	A Federal Court process reviewing whether the officer's decision was legally or procedurally sound - requires the Court's leave, within a strict deadline.	Best suited to a genuine legal or procedural error - consider professional advice before pursuing this.
Reapplication	A new application, assessed fresh, generally with an updated or reissued Letter of Acceptance if enough time has passed.	The most common path - confirm with your DLI whether your existing Letter of Acceptance is still valid.

If your Letter of Acceptance is involved

If the refusal cites a mismatch or your intended start date has passed, contact your DLI's international office promptly - they may be able to reissue your Letter of Acceptance for a later intake, but this takes time to arrange.

If financial evidence was the issue

- Recheck the exact formula in the Financial Requirements Overview - a shortfall is often a specific, fixable calculation error rather than a general lack of funds
- Confirm your evidence was in an accepted form (GIC, bank statements showing an ongoing pattern, loan letter, etc.)
- If you're bringing family members, confirm you included their additional living-cost amount too

If your study plan was the issue

Read the refusal reasons for the specific concern raised about your genuineness or academic fit. A reapplication should directly and specifically address that concern, with a clearer, more specific study plan - see the Study Plan Templates (Complete tier).

What not to do

- Don't reapply with the same evidence and study plan unchanged
- Don't omit a previous refusal on a later application
- Don't submit a Letter of Acceptance or documents you know to be inaccurate to work around a previous refusal

When to seek professional advice

Consider consulting a Regulated Canadian Immigration Consultant (RCIC) or immigration lawyer if you've been refused multiple times, if your case involves complex academic history, or if you believe the refusal involved a genuine procedural error.